WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

MOLDOVA

Europe

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Chișinău	Capital and economic centre; seat of the government, the National Bank and most IT and services companies	IT and software, business services, finance, construction
Free economic zones (Bălți, Ungheni and others)	Zones offering 0% VAT on supplies within the zone and customs relief, with separate warehousing and production regimes under Law 313/2025	Automotive components, electronics, textiles, export assembly
Industrial parks network	12 parks on 252.8 hectares with 145 residents employing 4,392 people at the end of 2025	Manufacturing, agri-processing, construction materials
Giurgiulești International Free Port	Moldova's only deep-water port, on the Danube and Prut, with an expansion planned	Grain and oil logistics, storage, transit to Ukraine and Romania
Bălți and the north	Second city and northern agricultural and industrial centre close to Romania and Ukraine	Agri-food, wine, manufacturing
Central and southern wine regions	Heart of a wine sector whose exports exceeded $149 million in 2025	Wine, horticulture, food processing, tourism
Prut border corridor (Ungheni, Leușeni)	Main road and rail links to Romania and the EU, and a route for Ukraine-related trade	Logistics, cross-border manufacturing, energy interconnection

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Invest Moldova Agency, the national investment and export promotion agency, providing investor guidance, site selection and aftercare
- Investment law guarantees including non-discrimination, protection against unlawful expropriation and free transfer of profits, with 39 bilateral investment treaties; new legislation is set to replace Law 81/2004
- A 12% corporate income tax, among the lowest in the region, with SMEs able to defer tax on profits reinvested in 2023–26
- Moldova Innovation Technology Park: a 7% single tax on turnover for IT companies, with fiscal stability guaranteed until 2035
- Regional State Aid Scheme for manufacturing: grants and corporate tax exemption covering up to 60% of eligible costs for investments from MDL 10 million
- Free economic zones and industrial parks with customs, VAT and infrastructure benefits for export manufacturers

- EU candidate status and the Deep and Comprehensive Free Trade Area, with free trade agreements covering 47 countries

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Moldova in November 2026 offers investors a low-tax, EU-oriented base on the EU's eastern border, with accession negotiations under way and strong EU financial support. GDP grew 2.4% in 2025, and growth improved to 0.9% year-on-year in the second quarter of 2026 from 0.4% in the first, led by a 13.6% rise in exports and higher manufacturing, agriculture and energy output. Net foreign direct investment reached $459.5 million in 2025, taking the FDI stock to $6.32 billion, 84.5% of it from EU investors. The EU opened the first negotiating cluster with Moldova on 15 June 2026, and the €1.9 billion Reform and Growth Facility continues to disburse, with a third payment of €157 million in October 2026 bringing the total made available to €661 million. The IT park, where 2,725 resident companies generated turnover of MDL 18.9 billion in 2025, is a standout success.

Moldova's main structural challenges are energy security and rising inflation within a small, open economy. Inflation reached 6.96% in August 2026, above the National Bank's target range, and the bank raised its base rate in steps from 5% in May to 9% in September. The IMF expects a wider budget deficit of 4.8% of GDP in 2026, driven largely by higher capital spending. Energy resilience is improving: renewable capacity has passed 1,000 MW and supplied 29.1% of electricity consumption in 2025, and new interconnection with Romania is under way, while gas supply to the Transnistrian region is managed by Moldovagaz under arrangements running to the end of 2026. A new government led by Prime Minister Vasile Tofan, appointed in July 2026, has pledged privatisation, fiscal discipline and an accession treaty by 2028, creating opportunities in energy, infrastructure and export manufacturing.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Inflation and tighter monetary policy	Inflation reached 6.96% in August 2026 and the base rate rose to 9%, raising borrowing costs	The National Bank expects a return to target in 2027; use EU-backed and DFI finance in euros for longer-term projects
Energy security and costs	Moldova has relied on imported energy and the Transnistrian region's gas supply remains under temporary arrangements	Growing renewables and interconnection with Romania reduce exposure; on-site generation and storage are opportunities in their own right
Transnistrian region	The breakaway region east of the Dniester is outside the control of the constitutional authorities	Locate operations on the right bank under Moldovan and EU-aligned law, and take legal advice on any Transnistria-linked dealings
Political volatility	The previous prime minister stepped down after eight months and the opposition is challenging the President	The pro-EU majority remains in place and EU accession and Growth Plan conditions anchor policy continuity
Regional security	Moldova borders Ukraine and is exposed to the effects of the war and to hybrid pressure	EU support and closer integration with Romania strengthen resilience; include routine contingency planning
Small market and labour supply	A population of about 2.4 million limits the domestic market and skilled labour	Use Moldova as an export base for the EU and Ukraine, and partner with universities and the IT park for skills
Governance and reform delivery	Judicial and anti-corruption reforms remain a work in progress, and two Growth Plan steps were missed in early 2026	EU and IMF conditionality supports steady reform; use the investment law's guarantees and international arbitration

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Moldova's risk profile is that of a small, reforming EU candidate on the frontier of the Russia–Ukraine war. Its strengths are clear: a 12% corporate tax, a successful IT park, EU candidate status with negotiations opened in June 2026, and €1.9 billion of EU Growth Plan support for 2025–27. The main near-term issues are inflation of

6.96% and a base rate of 9%, a wider budget deficit, energy security and the unresolved status of the Transnistrian region, whose gas supply is under temporary arrangements to the end of 2026. Political turnover in 2026 produced a new government with continued pro-EU direction. Moldova is not on the FATF grey list, and EU-aligned reforms are steadily strengthening the investment climate; investors should focus on right-bank locations and take advice on any Transnistria-linked dealings.

MARKET ACCESS

Moldova trades with the EU under its Association Agreement and Deep and Comprehensive Free Trade Area, and its free trade agreements cover 47 countries and a market of more than 870 million consumers. It is a WTO member and EU accession negotiations opened in June 2026, steadily aligning Moldovan rules with the single market. Romania is the main gateway to the EU, with road and rail crossings on the Prut and energy and gas interconnections, while trade with Ukraine reached an estimated $1.32 billion in 2025. The Giurgiulești port on the Danube gives access to the Black Sea, and Moldova is positioning itself as a logistics and supply base for Ukraine's reconstruction.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Government of Moldova (Prime Minister Vasile Tofan)	The government appointed in July 2026 has prioritised economic revival, privatisation, deficit reduction and EU accession	Primary reference point for strategic direction and major projects
Invest Moldova Agency	National agency for investment and export promotion, publishing the investor guide and supporting new investors	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentives
National Bank of Moldova	Sets the base rate (9% since September 2026), supervises banks and manages the exchange-rate regime	Relevant for banking, currency and payments
Ministry of Economic Development and Digitalisation	Oversees investment policy, state aid, free economic zones, industrial parks and the IT park	Counterpart on incentives and business regulation
Ministry of Energy	Leads energy security, interconnection with Romania and renewable-energy auctions	Key counterpart for energy and infrastructure investment
Moldova Innovation Technology Park	Virtual IT park administering the 7% single-tax regime for 2,725 resident companies	Entry route for IT, software and digital services companies
Office of the President (President Maia Sandu)	Sets foreign-policy and EU accession direction and nominates the prime minister	Reference point for the EU integration agenda

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The American Chamber of Commerce in Moldova, the Foreign Investors Association, the European Business Association and the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of the Republic of Moldova are the main business associations, with regular dialogue with government on reforms. Invest Moldova organises investor events and has studied Moldova's role in Ukraine's reconstruction, and the annual EU–Moldova Association Council and Growth Plan reviews set the reform agenda. The EBRD, the European Investment Bank, the World Bank and IFC are active in energy, transport, finance and private-sector development, and EU-funded programmes offer co-financing for qualifying projects.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Moldova suits investors seeking a low-cost, low-tax base aligned with EU rules: export manufacturers in automotive components, electronics and textiles using free economic zones, industrial parks and state aid; IT and software firms using the 7% IT park regime; energy investors in renewables, storage and interconnection; agri-food and wine producers; and logistics companies supporting EU–Ukraine trade and Ukraine's reconstruction.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage Invest Moldova and select an incentive regime
Compare free economic zones, industrial parks, the IT park and the Regional State Aid Scheme against the project's profile.

STEP 2: Shortlist sites with good access to the EU
Assess locations in Chișinău, Bălți, Ungheni and the Prut corridor for access to Romania and EU markets.

STEP 3: Map EU and DFI funding
Identify Growth Plan, EU programme and EBRD or EIB finance that can support energy, infrastructure or manufacturing components.

STEP 4: Plan for energy and inflation
Build energy-price and inflation scenarios into financial models, and consider on-site generation or storage.

STEP 5: Track accession and the political calendar
Monitor EU accession clusters, Growth Plan disbursements and the government's privatisation programme.